



EDUCATION ABROAD PROGRAM PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

This checklist includes practical components of program development and delivery that may involve various stakeholders. It is designed to be customizable to your institutional context.

	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
PROGRAM CONCEPTUALIZATION		
☐ Review your institution's mission and curricular goals		
☐ Identify and gather key stakeholders/ partners: ☐ Education Abroad office ☐ Supportive faculty from diverse disciplines ☐ Student Affairs leadership ☐ Academic Affairs leadership ☐ Financial Aid Office ☐ Registrar's Office ☐ Finance and Business Office ☐ Student Government leadership		
☐ Determine: ☐ Mission and goals for education abroad (aligned to institutional mission and goals) ☐ Types of education abroad programs desired • Direct Enroll • International Education Organization • Exchange (bi-lateral or otherwise) • Internship or Community Based Learning Partnerships • Faculty-led		

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PROGRAM CONCEPTUALIZATION (continued)	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
○ Institutional approach to financing education abroad • Operational budget allocation • Fees charged to students for application or participation ○ Standards of evaluating credits earned on education abroad ○ Semester or annual participation goals • Strategy for engaging underrepresented and historically excluded students ○ Staffing needs based on anticipated participation ○ Financial structure for students • Home tuition model • Tiered model • Program fees model • Another model • Application or participation fees ○ Financial aid allocation plan (dependent on student financial structure) ○ Risk assessment plan (authorized travel, risk review, protocols for appeal, financial risk, insurance coverage)		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		

	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
PROGRAM IMPLEMENTATION		
☐ Establish oversight committee (ad hoc or formal)		
☐ Establish program approval process		
☐ Identify education abroad programs that align with the institution's mission, goals, and financial structure		
☐ Establish Memoranda of Understanding (MOUs) and partnership agreements signed by institutional leadership		
☐ Establish course credit transfer process		
☐ Design application process: ○ Timeline for applications ○ Eligibility for participation (GPA, class year, pre-requisites, language proficiency, student conduct history) ○ Required information and materials (e.g., transcripts, letters of recommendations, essays) ○ Individual(s) or committee tasked with conducting application review and selection ○ Enrollment caps		
☐ Design advising and pre-departure orientation: ○ Student advising philosophy and structure ○ Communication of policies and expectations for participation • Handbook • Standard emails • Marketing ○ Orientation program for participants • Design Emergency Action Plan • Design Re-entry Program		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		

	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
PROGRAM EVALUATION AND ASSESSMENT		
☐ Design student evaluation survey		
☐ Design student learning assessment protocol		
☐ Review both at the end of each term		
☐ Establish Site Visit timelines and protocol		
☐ Establish an MOU/Agreement Review timeline (typically 3 or 5 years)		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		

	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
PROGRAM BUDGETING AND PLANNING		
☐ Identify staffing needs		
☐ Establish annual operating budget needs		
☐ Determine financial aid allocation policies ☐ Institutional aid (need and merit) ☐ Federal aid ☐ Loans ☐ Any limitations to aid allocation		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		

	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
STUDENT ADVISING, RECRUITMENT, SELECTION, AND RETENTION		
☐ Create marketing materials that reflect what students can expect on education abroad programs ○ Clear deadlines ○ Financial aid availability ○ Scholarship availability ○ Credit transfer expectations		
☐ Develop recruitment plan ○ Include strategies actively inclusive of historically underserved students		
☐ Make application(s) available		
☐ Advising checklist: ○ Determine student's eligibility for education abroad and desired program(s) ○ Discuss student's goals for education abroad (academic, professional, and personal) ○ Discuss credit transfer process and expectations ○ Discuss financial aid policies and availability of scholarships ○ Discuss program-specific information • Course availability • Housing format (apartment, residence hall, home stay, independent) • Opportunities for internships or community-based learning • Included excursions • Cost of living and currency exchange ○ Prepare to advise on the significance of student identities in the host country (including but not limited to race, ethnicity, sexuality, gender, religion, ability, and socioeconomic status) ○ Provide overview of application and selection process		

	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
STUDENT ADVISING, RECRUITMENT, SELECTION, AND RETENTION (continued)		
☐ Select students and confirm eligibility		
☐ Communicate expectations of participation: ☐ What constitutes a revocation of approval to participate?		
☐ Inform relevant campus stakeholders of participation: ☐ Academic advisor ☐ Registrar ☐ Financial aid ☐ Student Life and Housing ☐ Health and Wellness Services		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		

	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
STUDENT PREPARATION AND PRE-DEPARTURE ORIENTATION		
☐ Hold Pre-departure Orientation: ☐ Communicate expectations for participation ☐ Include information about: • Institutional policies related to academics, student behavior/ conduct, financial aid • Availability of or recommendations for international insurance coverage • Travel documents (passports and visas) and how to obtain them • Housing availability • Budgeting for the term abroad • Goal setting and achievement • Country-specific information • Emergency protocol/procedures • Provide resources on: ▪ Managing health and safety ▪ Navigating identities abroad ▪ Career planning and education abroad		
☐ Pre-program course credit approval		
☐ Assist students where possible on: ☐ Travel documentation acquisition ☐ External scholarship applications		
☐ Communicate with families about how to support students on education abroad (as appropriate)		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		

	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
DURING THE PROGRAM		
☐ Communicate any updates to policies and procedures		
☐ Schedule check-ins with participating students		
☐ Communicate with host institutions or partners, request status updates, share concerns, or request information as needed		
☐ Communicate with participating students in response to local events or emergencies		
☐ Submit insurance claims as needed		
☐ Follow conduct or behavior violation protocols		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		

	Responsible Party	Timeline/Due Date
RE-ENTRY: STUDENT RETURN AND TRANSITION		
☐ Send program evaluations to students		
☐ Review submitted evaluations, note any patterns, follow up with students or partners with concerns		
☐ Initiate learning outcomes assessment		
☐ Hold re-entry event ○ Reflection activity for participants ○ Share opportunities to leverage new knowledge and cross-cultural proficiencies on and off campus ○ Encourage returnees to volunteer as education abroad ambassadors		
☐ Share outcomes with relevant oversight committee and academic departments		
☐ Compile and report participation statistics to institutional leadership		
☐ Celebrate accomplishments by sharing positive outcomes and appreciation for stakeholders: ○ Academic Affairs ○ Student Life ○ Finance and Administration ○ Colleges and Academic Departments ○ Communications ○ Alumni Engagement and Development ○ Program Partners		
☐ Other:		
☐ Other:		